

CHAPTER SUMMARY

WHAT EVERY VENUE NEEDS TO GET RIGHT

Whether you run a 300-seat club or a 60,000-seat stadium, the same principles govern how guests decide to come back. These are the five that matter most.

1

THE GUEST EXPERIENCE BEGINS BEFORE THE GATE AND ENDS AFTER THE PARKING LOT

Discovery, purchase, arrival, entry, F&B, the event, exit, and post-event follow-up are not separate departments. They are one seamless guest experience. A failure at any stage contaminates the memory as a whole.

2

FRICTION IS A REVENUE PROBLEM, NOT JUST AN EXPERIENCE PROBLEM

Every guest who abandons a concession line is a lost sale. Every guest whose first-time experience feels chaotic is lost revenue. Friction has a dollar value — and it compounds across every event, every season, every year the problem goes unfixed.

3

PREMIUM EXPERIENCES MUST DELIVER END-TO-END — NOT JUST AT THE SEAT

A guest in a VIP suite paid for a complete experience, not a better view. One failure — slow service, a broken app, a chaotic exit — destroys the premium argument entirely and ends the conversation before it starts.

4

THE POST-EVENT WINDOW IS UNTAPPED REVENUE FOR MOST VENUES

The 24–48 hours after a great event are the highest-value marketing window a venue has. Most waste it with silence or generic messaging. A personalized, timely follow-up in that window converts single-event buyers into multi-year loyalists at a fraction of acquiring a new customer.

5

THE COMPETITION IS NO LONGER THE VENUE ACROSS TOWN — IT'S THE COUCH

Fans have a high-quality, frictionless alternative to attending in person. Every operational failure is an argument for staying home next time. Making the live experience worth the effort — every time — is the whole competitive strategy.

NEXT → CHAPTER 5

THE RESTAURANT AND BAR VERTICAL

How America's most competitive hospitality vertical rewards operators who master AND THE CROWD gap — and what the highest-volume restaurants do differently at every table turn.

